

FREE BONUS

Fresh at Serving

The Amish Finishing Recipes

The dumplings, noodles, and crusts your jar has been waiting for

---

The jar holds everything. You bring the rest.

Four recipes for the fresh elements that complete the most iconic Amish dishes in the book — ready in under 20 minutes.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

01 Boova Shenkel Dumplings — for Beef and Dumpling Stew
02 Schnitz un Knepp Dumplings — for Pork and Dried Apple Stew
03 Homemade Egg Noodles — for any broth in the book
04 Amish Pot Pie Crust — for Chicken Pot Pie Filling

About This Guide

Several recipes in *The Ultimate Amish Canning Meat Cookbook for Beginners* are marked 'fresh at serving' — meaning a finishing element is prepared on the day you open the jar, not inside the jar itself. The canned base is complete and fully flavored without it. The fresh element is what the Amish cook adds at the table.

This guide contains the four fresh-at-serving recipes referenced in the book:

Recipe in the book	Chapter	Fresh element
Beef and Dumpling Stew (Boova Shenkel)	Chapter 4 — Beef	**Boova Shenkel Dumplings**
Pork and Dried Apple Stew (Schnitz un Knepp)	Chapter 5 — Pork	**Schnitz un Knepp Dumplings**
Wedding Roast / any broth recipe	Chapters 4, 5, 6, 7	**Homemade Egg Noodles**
Chicken Pot Pie Filling	Chapter 6 — Poultry	**Amish Pot Pie Crust**

How to use this guide: Open the jar. Heat the contents. While the jar heats, make the fresh element. By the time the jar is hot, the dumplings, noodles, or crust are ready. That is the Amish timing — everything arrives at the table together.

01 — Boova Shenkel Dumplings

For Beef and Dumpling Stew (Boova Shenkel) · Chapter 4

In Pennsylvania Dutch, Boova Shenkel means 'boy's legs' — a reference to the shape of the dumplings. They are soft, pillowy, and designed to absorb the rich beef broth they cook in. Do not lift the lid while they cook.

Yield	Prep time	Cook time	Serves
7–8 dumplings	**5 min**	**12–15 min**	**3–4**

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup all-purpose flour
- 1½ tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp canning salt
- ½ tsp dried parsley (optional)
- ½ cup whole milk
- 1 tbsp unsalted butter, melted

METHOD

1. Heat the jar contents in a large pot over medium heat until simmering. You need at least 2 inches of broth above the meat for the dumplings to cook properly. Add ½ cup of water or beef broth if needed.
2. While the stew heats, combine flour, baking powder, salt, and parsley in a bowl. Stir to combine.
3. Add milk and melted butter. Stir until just combined — do not overmix. The batter should be thick and slightly sticky. Lumps are fine.
4. When the stew is simmering, drop the batter by heaped spoonfuls onto the surface of the liquid — not into the liquid. Leave space between each dumpling as they expand.
5. Cover the pot immediately and cook for 12–15 minutes without lifting the lid. The dumplings steam-cook in the trapped heat. Lifting the lid releases the steam and they will not cook through.
6. After 12–15 minutes, test one dumpling by cutting it in half — it should be cooked through with no wet batter in the center. Serve immediately directly from the pot.

> **Amish tip:** *The Amish cook drops dumpling dough by the spoonful without measuring each one precisely. Uneven dumplings are part of the character of the dish — some will be larger, some smaller. All will be good.*

02 — Schnitz un Knepp Dumplings

For Pork and Dried Apple Stew (Schnitz un Knepp) · Chapter 5

Schnitz un Knepp dumplings are slightly sweeter and more delicate than Boova Shenkel dumplings — the apple-and-pork broth they cook in calls for something lighter. The small amount of sugar is traditional and essential.

Yield	Prep time	Cook time	Serves
8–10 dumplings	**5 min**	**12–15 min**	**3–4**

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup all-purpose flour
- 1½ tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp canning salt
- 1 tsp sugar
- ¼ tsp ground allspice
- ½ cup whole milk
- 1 tbsp unsalted butter, melted

METHOD

1. Heat the jar contents in a large pot over medium heat until simmering. The sweet-sour broth from the dried apples and pork will be fragrant — this is correct.
2. Combine flour, baking powder, salt, sugar, and allspice in a bowl. Stir to combine.
3. Add milk and melted butter. Stir until just combined. The batter will be slightly thinner than Boova Shenkel batter — this gives the dumplings a lighter texture that suits the sweeter broth.
4. Drop batter by heaped spoonfuls onto the simmering surface of the stew. The allspice in the dumplings echoes the spice profile of the braised pork underneath.
5. Cover immediately and cook 12–15 minutes without lifting the lid.
6. Serve directly from the pot. The dumplings should be soft throughout with a slight sweetness that complements the apple-pork broth.

> **Amish tip:** *Schnitz un Knepp is the dish that Amish mothers have made for Sunday dinner for generations. The name of the dish — dried apples and buttons — refers to the dumplings' resemblance to buttons. Make them small for a more traditional result.*

03 — Homemade Egg Noodles

For any broth recipe in the book · Chapters 4, 5, 6, and 7

Amish egg noodles are wider and thicker than Italian pasta — more substantial, more absorbent, and better suited to the rich broths in this book. They take 20 minutes from flour to table. Store-bought egg noodles work perfectly well, but homemade are worth the effort at least once.

Yield	Prep time	Rest time	Cook time
4 servings	**10 min**	**5 min**	**5–7 min**

INGREDIENTS

- 1½ cups all-purpose flour, plus extra for rolling
- 2 large eggs
- 2 tbsp whole milk
- ½ tsp canning salt

METHOD

1. Combine flour and salt in a bowl and make a well in the center. Beat eggs with milk and pour into the well. Mix with a fork until a shaggy dough forms, then knead by hand for 2–3 minutes until smooth. The dough should be firm, not sticky — add flour a tablespoon at a time if needed.
2. Cover the dough with a cloth and rest for 5 minutes. This relaxes the gluten and makes rolling easier.
3. Flour a clean surface generously. Roll the dough as thin as you can — approximately ⅛ inch. Amish noodles are cut wide: aim for strips ½ inch to ¾ inch wide and 3–4 inches long. Cut with a sharp knife or pizza cutter.
4. Bring a pot of salted water to a boil, or add the noodles directly to a pot of simmering broth from the jar for richer flavor.
5. Cook for 5–7 minutes until tender but with some bite. Fresh noodles cook much faster than dried — taste after 5 minutes.
6. Serve in the bowl topped with meat and broth from the jar, ladled generously.

> **Amish tip:** *Amish cooks make noodles by feel rather than by measurement — the dough is ready when it is smooth and does not stick to the board. If you are new to pasta dough, err on the side of more flour rather than less. A slightly stiff dough rolls more easily than a sticky one.*

💡 **No time for homemade?** Wide egg noodles from any supermarket work well in all the broth recipes in this book. Pennsylvania Dutch-style egg noodles by Amish Country brand are available in many US supermarkets and online — they are the closest commercial equivalent to homemade.

04 — Amish Pot Pie Crust

For Chicken Pot Pie Filling · Chapter 6

Amish pot pie is not the crimped, dome-lidded pie of American diners. It is a deep-dish bake with a thick, biscuit-like crust pressed into the top of the filling — rustic, substantial, and designed to soak up the chicken and celery gravy underneath it.

Yield	Prep time	Bake time	Oven
1 crust for 7-qt filling	**10 min**	**20–25 min**	**400°F / 200°C**

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1 tsp canning salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ⅓ cup cold unsalted butter, cubed
- ¾ cup whole milk
- 1 tbsp unsalted butter, melted (for brushing)

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F (200°C).
2. Heat the jar contents in a saucepan over medium heat. If you want a thicker filling, stir in 2 tablespoons of cornstarch dissolved in 2 tablespoons of cold water and cook until slightly thickened. Pour into a 9x13 baking dish or a deep ovenproof skillet.
3. Combine flour, baking powder, salt, and pepper in a bowl. Add cold butter cubes and rub between your fingers until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs with some pea-sized pieces remaining. Cold butter is essential — it creates the flaky texture.
4. Add milk and stir until just combined. Do not overmix. The dough will be shaggy and sticky — this is correct.
5. Drop the dough by large spoonfuls over the surface of the hot filling. Spread gently with the back of a spoon — it does not need to cover every inch. Brush with melted butter.
6. Bake for 20–25 minutes until the crust is golden brown and the filling is bubbling around the edges. Rest for 5 minutes before serving.

> **Amish tip:** *The Amish pot pie crust is a drop biscuit, not a rolled pastry. The rough, uneven surface that results from dropping the dough by spoonfuls is intentional — it creates more surface area for browning and more edges to soak up the gravy underneath.*

💡 **Shortcut:** Store-bought refrigerated biscuit dough (Pillsbury Grands or similar) placed on top of the filling and baked at 375°F for 18–20 minutes produces an excellent result with almost no preparation time.